SYED ZARAK HASSAN

Nottingham, England, United Kingdom (Open to Relocation) | +44 7746 712125 | syedzrk1000@gmail.com

zarak-os.vercel.app | github.com/syed-hassan7 | linkedin.com/in/zarak-hassan7

Professional Summary

Technical Builder and GRC professional bridging software engineering and cyber security. Wrapped up 1 Year placement at Thrive Learning (as part of my Masters) where I built production ready tools to automate compliance bottlenecks. I focus on making manual compliance friction obsolete through automation, having built internal systems that reduced contract approval cycles by 70%. Outside of GRC, I co led a startup design agency for 3 years, managing 15+ client accounts. I hold a BSc in Software Engineering and am completing an MSc in Cyber Security. Looking for GRC Engineer, Analyst and other relevant Information Security roles.

Technical Skills and Core Competencies

Compliance Frameworks: ISO 27001, ISO 9001, SOC 2, GDPR, Cyber Essentials. (Working knowledge: HIPAA, ISO 42001, EU AI Act)
GRC Operations: Third Party and Vendor Risk Management, Risk Registers, DPA Tracking, Audit Readiness, Security Questionnaires (RFI, RFQ), Access Control, Iru MCP Automation Workflows.
Platforms: Vanta, Cakewalk, Jira, Pulseway, Kandji/Iru.
Security Ops: Endpoint Management, Incident Investigation and Response, Security Awareness Training.
SIEM (Educational): Splunk, Chronicle, Suricata, Wireshark, VirusTotal, BitDefender GravityZone
Technical: TypeScript, Next.js, Supabase (PostgreSQL, Row Level Security), HuggingFace, Render, Claude API, Claude Code, Cursor (Cursor SDK Development), Devin, Codex, Tailwind CSS, Vercel, n8n.

Professional Experience

GRC Analyst - Thrive Learning, Nottingham, UK
September 2025 - September 2026 (1 Year Internship)

Key Achievements:

- Guided the business through a successful ISO 9001 Stage 1 audit by designing 6 end-to-end process flows for non-technical teams.
- Delivered a high-value prospect RFI by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure.
- Cut contract and DPA approval time by 70% by redesigning the company-wide DPA tracking process and building ContraAI, an internal AI-powered contract review platform, for procurement and legal teams.
- Led MDM migration to Kandji/Iru across 250+ endpoints with zero downtime, reducing IT support tickets by 40%.
- Identified the Shai-Hulud NPM supply chain threat and engineered a custom scan + remediation script deployed via Iru to secure the developer fleet immediately.

Responsibilities:

- Owned third-party risk management for 50+ vendors in Vanta, maintaining risk classifications and customer assurance programmes.
- Maintained GRC risk registers and security controls across vendor, asset, access, and risk domains for continuous audit readiness.
- Managed 75+ application ownership records in Cakewalk, assigning security and business owners across the application estate.
- Developed the company-wide DPA tracker, coordinating supplier and contract lifecycle activities with procurement for GDPR compliance.
- Resolved customer due-diligence requests and security questionnaires, improving response speed and quality across the business.

Co Founder and Commercial Lead - Nexique Design Labs, Pakistan
September 2021 - August 2024

- Owned the entire GTM and delivery pipeline for 3 years, securing $8,500+ in revenue across 15+ accounts by leading all cold outreach, phone calling, and organic lead generation from first contact to project sign off.
- Achieved a 98% satisfaction rate and maintained a 7% churn rate across 3 years by managing the full account lifecycle, ensuring recurring business that consistently outweighed customer loss.
- Built a custom Notion based CRM and project management system from scratch to track revenue, leads, and delivery timelines, replacing fragmented manual spreadsheets.
- Developed organic marketing strategies and video content that gained 50k+ views, driving significant new business without a paid marketing budget.
- Mentored a team of 5 interns, creating structured tutorials and automated workflows to get them productive quickly without pulling senior time away from delivery.

Projects & Tools

VenderScope - Continuous Vendor Risk Intelligence Platform
github.com/syed-hassan7/venderscope | venderscope.vercel.app

- Built out of frustration managing 50+ vendor audits manually in Vanta at Thrive Learning. Monitors vendor estates 24/7 across HIBP, NVD/NIST, Shodan, and Companies House, replacing annual reviews with a live weighted risk score (0–100).
- Used in real audit workflows alongside Vanta to surface breach history, active CVEs, exposed infrastructure, and compliance evidence across ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, and Cyber Essentials.
- Generates one-click PDF audit reports structured for ISO 27001 Annex A and Cyber Essentials reviews, with a risk score drift timeline showing how a vendor's posture changes over time.

ContraAI - AI-Powered Contract Review Platform **(Internal Thrive Learning Tool)**

- Engineered an AI powered contract review engine using Next.js 15 and the Claude API to analyze complex legal documents against a configurable company playbook.
- Automates detection of high risk clauses and provides instant negotiation guidance for legal teams — the tool behind the 70% cut in contract/DPA approval time achieved during the DPA process redesign.
- Implemented a deterministic risk scoring system that tiers contracts from Acceptable to Critical based on playbook deviations rather than model variance.
- Built a full immutable audit trail for every sensitive action including clause reviews and user invites to meet strict internal GRC logging requirements.
- Developed a DPA specific intelligence module that detects subprocessor gaps and flags missing required
- clauses automatically.
- Designed a role based governance model (Viewer, Legal, Admin) to ensure sensitive contract data is only accessible to authorized personnel.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security
Nottingham Trent University, UK | January 2025 - December 2026 (Expected)

- **Dissertation**: Investigated whether diagrammatic techniques improve auditor comprehension of complex systems, combining case studies and interviews to demonstrate measurable improvements in understanding at small scale.
- **Relevant modules**: Network Security, Digital Forensics, Secure Software Development and Ethical Hacking.

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering
Iqra National University, Pakistan | February 2020 - February 2024

- Graduated with **Distinction**.

Certifications

Google Professional Cyber Security Certificate (2024) / Coursera and Google

SOC Analyst Learning Path (2024) / LetsDefend and HackTheBox